

6 280100 002330

WEDNESDAY
APRIL 8, 2026
SHAWWAL 20, 1447

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES

Dominic & Partners

Partner for a better tomorrow.
Audit | Tax | Advisory

Branches: Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, RAK and Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Suite B 3001, Latifa tower, Sheikh Zayed Road, Dubai
info@domuae.com | www.domuae.com | Dubai +971 56 6040 648 | +971 50 9801 263

3545758.11

UAE steps up relief measures, price control

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The UAE is rolling out co-ordinated measures to contain cost pressures and support businesses, as global fuel volatility and regional developments continue to impact supply chains and economic activity.

Suhail Mohammed Al Mazrouei, Minister of Energy and Infrastructure, said authorities have introduced a mechanism to limit the impact of rising fuel prices on consumer goods. He noted that recent global fuel price movements have disrupted supply chains and influenced broader economic conditions. Despite this, the UAE has moved to ensure that cost increases are not passed on disproportionately to consumers.

According to Al Mazrouei, goods are affected by multiple cost components before reaching the domestic market. Authorities are now working with the Ministry of Economy and Tourism to increase transparency around shipping and logistics costs, making it harder for traders or carriers to inflate prices.

Business support

In parallel, banks are introducing additional relief measures to help businesses manage operational pressures. Emirates NBD has launched a Business Support Package for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), offering temporary fee waivers and reduced charges to support cash flow and day-to-day operations.

The programme includes discounts on trade finance and cash management services, aimed at easing working capital constraints as companies adjust to higher logistics costs and shifting payment cycles. The move aligns with broader economic support measures, including a Dh1 billion initiative approved by the Dubai Government and a Dh1 trillion Financial Institution Resilience Package introduced by the Central Bank of UAE.

SEE ALSO P7



■ Displaced people wait to receive donated food near the tents they use as shelters after fleeing Israeli bombardment in Beirut, Lebanon.

AP

RUSSIA AND CHINA VETO UN HORMUZ RESOLUTION AMID RISING TENSIONS

Gulf states 'regret' rejection as push to secure strait stalls

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Russia and China vetoed a UN Security Council resolution yesterday calling for action to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, blocking a measure that had already been watered down from earlier Gulf proposals seeking authorisation to use force to secure the critical shipping lane.

The Bahrain-drafted resolution, backed by the United States, received 11 votes in favour, with Russia and China opposed and Pakistan and Colombia abstaining.

Bahrain's Foreign Minister Abdullatif Bin Rashid Al Zayani said Gulf states "regret" the rejection, noting the original proposal had sought Chapter VII authorisation that would have allowed member states to act to ensure freedom of navigation.

The vote came amid mounting concern over global economic fallout from disruptions to energy flows.

Earlier, the UAE Mission to the UN warned that rising food and fuel prices and supply chain disruptions were already affecting billions worldwide, calling for urgent international action to safeguard shipping through Hormuz.

On the ground, tensions continued to play out.

The UAE Ministry of Defence said its air defence systems intercepted one ballistic missile and 11 drones launched from Iran.

Two injured

In Sharjah, authorities responded to a ballistic missile strike in the Central Region. Two Pakistani nationals sustained moderate injuries and were taken to hospital.

Dr Anwar Gargash, adviser to the UAE President, described

Iran as a "treacherous regime that cannot be trusted", saying it had attacked neighbouring states despite efforts to avoid a conflict.

He added that the current moment demands clarity in political positions, with countries judged by how firmly they defend their sovereignty, people and achievements.

The conflict has been accompanied by escalating rhetoric from Washington.

Dire warning

US President Donald Trump, ahead of his self-imposed Tuesday midnight (GMT) deadline, warned that "a whole civilisation will die" in Iran if it does not accept US demands, while he has previously said strikes could target bridges, power plants and other infrastructure. According to *The Wall Street Journal*, Iran has

cut direct contact with Washington following the threat.

Vice-President JD Vance said the United States still has "tools" it has not yet used.

Meanwhile, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said Israeli forces had struck railways and bridges used by the Revolutionary Guards, with Iranian officials reporting damage to transport and power infrastructure.

Oil markets reacted to the developments, with crude prices rising amid reports of strikes near Iran's key export hub at Kharg Island, though US officials said oil facilities were not targeted.

Diplomatic efforts continue, with Pakistan attempting to sustain talks, while Qatar has warned the conflict risks "spiralling out of control" without a resolution.

SEE ALSO P4, 5, 8, 12-13

ON GULFNEWS.COM

Check out the latest developments in the US-Israel-Iran war

Artemis II crew snaps historic Earthset photo on way home



■ In this image provided by Nasa, the Artemis II crew captured this view as the Earth sets behind the Moon.

AP

Picture taken more than 57 years after the shot by an Apollo 8 astronaut

HOUSTON

The Artemis II astronauts snapped a stunning shot of Earthset — the moment when the Earth dips below the Moon's horizon — on their long journey back home yesterday after wrapping up a historic lunar flyby.

Nasa released the photo of Earth dropping below the rugged lunar edge in a deliberate nod to the iconic Earthrise image taken

After completing their lunar flyby — breaking the record for distance from Earth — they were bound for home, with splashdown due in the Pacific off the coast of California late Friday.

by an Apollo 8 astronaut in 1968. That shot 57 years ago helped capture the public's imagination when it was taken by US astronaut Bill Anders during the first space mission to carry humans around the Moon.

Harsh, huge curve

The modern version pairs the delicate, watery planet Earth with the harsh, huge curve of the Moon, separated by black space.

"First photo from the far side

of the Moon," the White House said, reposting the image.

The crew of four — US astronauts Reid Wiseman, Christina Koch, and Victor Glover, teamed with Canadian Jeremy Hansen — are on a historic mission to loop around Earth's natural satellite as part of a broader program paving the way for a Moon landing in 2028.

After completing their lunar flyby — breaking the record for distance from Earth — they were

bound for home, with splashdown due in the Pacific off the coast of California late Friday. The crew reported in vivid detail features of the lunar surface and later witnessed a solar eclipse, when the Moon passed in front of the Sun. They also described flashes of light — meteor strikes — on the Moon's surface.

Late Monday, the crew got a congratulatory call from Nasa administrator Jared Isaacman and US President Donald Trump, who at 79 is old enough to remember the Apollo programme. "You've really inspired the entire world," Trump said, calling them "modern-day pioneers" who have "a lot of courage."

SEE ALSO P6

NATION

Parents not expected to play teachers' role during distance learning | P2

BUSINESS

SpaceX IPO: Can Elon Musk justify a \$1.75 trillion valuation? | P10

NATION

World Health Day: UAE doctors warn not to ignore symptoms | P3



SPORT

How KKR's Dh10 million Green investment backfired

IPL's costliest buy flops as batter, can't bowl | P14

Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com

www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions

Tel: 600 587 234

E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00